



Institute for Community Inclusion at UMass Boston, with support
from the Massachusetts Department of Developmental Services



Rebuilding the Foundation: A CBDS Webinar Series

- November 2023: CBDS Fundamentals
- December 2023: Integrating Person-Centered Planning and Thinking
- January: Community Mapping and Networking
- • TODAY: CBDS as a Pathway to Employment
- February 22nd: Volunteer, Internships and Unpaid Work Experiences



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CBDS as a Pathway to Employment: Agenda

- Understanding CBDS and natural intersection with employment
- Informed Choice, Employment and CBDS
- Pathway to Employment
 - Approach
 - Team
 - Activities and experiences
 - Documentation and Communication
- Stories from the Field



CBDS as a Pathway to Employment

- Belief: All individuals of working age should have the opportunity to work in the community
- Employment goal vs non-employment goal
- How:
 - Discover and explore
 - Practice and experience
 - Develop preferences and interests
 - Build relevant skills



Informed Choice

Process of choosing from options based on accurate information, knowledge, and experiences

Core principles of choice:

- Everyone is capable of making choices
- Choices are not unlimited
- Choices have consequences
- All choices aren't equal



Tools for Inclusion: Informed Choice and Employment



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Informed Choice, Employment, and CBDS



Provide information about benefits of working



Facilitate experiences in employment settings



Peer-to-Peer discussions



Identify and address any concerns or objections



Regularly revisit a decision to not work in community

[Tools for Inclusion: Informed Choice and Employment \(ICI 2020\)](#)

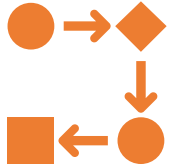


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Pathway to Employment



Approach:

How are you learning about the
folks you are supporting?
Moving beyond “Do you want to
work”
Tools to dig deeper



Team:

Individual in drivers seat
Role of Staff
Case Manager
Family/Caregiver



Maximize time in the community:

Identifying community based
opportunities
Purposeful Connections

Employment-Driven CBDS Activities

Career Exploration

- Volunteering
- Workplace Tours
- Job shadowing
- Situational assessments
- Internships
- Informational interviews
- Job clubs



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Skill Building through participation in CBDS activities



Travel Training

Health and wellness

Employment skill development

Vocational training and certifications

Classes/workshops

Job preparation

Managing public benefits



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Pulling it All Together

- Tracking, Documentation and Communication
- Referral to VR or Employment Services
- Direct Support Staff benefit from training on how to facilitate CBDS as a pathway to employment, inclusion and person-centered approaches



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Stories from the Field:

Matthew Gentile (M.Ed)

Director of DDS Services

Valley Collaborative

[Valley Collaborative-Website](#)



Hanna Bernbaum
Lead Career Coach
Jewish Vocational
Services (JVS)

[JVS Website](#)



SKILLS . JOBS . CAREERS



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Thank you for joining us today!

We want to hear from you! Please take a moment to complete this brief post-session survey.

[CBDS Pathway to Employment Survey](#)

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Resources

- Informed Choice and Employment: Overview
 - [Tools for Inclusion Issue No. 31 2020](#)
- Employment First MA
 - www.employmentfirstma.org
- Webinar: Informed Choice: It's More Than Just Asking
 - [Informed Choice and Employment Webinar](#)
- Ensuring Excellence in Community Based Day Supports: A Guide for Service Providers and Staff
 - [CBDS Brief](#)

